

INNOVATION AND EDUCATIONAL TECHNOLOGIES
GENERAL DIRECTORATE

ECO-FRIENDLY STEPS

Course	English	Grade	7th Grade	Duration	4 lesson hours (4x40')

This scenario is designed to assist teachers in providing an effective learning experience utilising technology. The teacher may utilise this scenario, which is presented as an exemplar, or adapt it to align with the specific requirements of the students and the physical conditions of the educational institution.

Overview

This learning scenario integrates environmental education with interactive, digital, and gamified approaches to foster language and 21st-century skills. The students expand their vocabulary on environmental issues, classify recyclable materials, and practice process descriptions, while engaging in digital storytelling, animations, and collaborative online tools. By following eco-friendly instructions, creating digital posters, and raising awareness through short messages, the students develop communication, critical thinking, responsibility, and digital literacy.

The teacher guides the process by preparing structured, step-by-step activities, modelling eco-friendly tasks, and encouraging the students to express obligations and instructions clearly. The students actively participate in digital games, collaborate on group tasks, and present their eco-friendly processes using visual and digital support. Assessment is embedded into the activities through classification tasks, quizzes, puzzles, and online exercises, enabling the teacher to monitor progress, while the students gain confidence in applying environmental vocabulary, sharing responsibilities, and reflecting on sustainable practices.

Key Concepts: Environmental awareness, Eco-friendly actions, Recycling

Learning Goals

Students

- Use and apply common environmental vocabulary appropriately in daily contexts.
- Identify and explain simple environmental processes through digital storytelling or animations.
- Express obligations and responsibilities about protecting nature and saving resources.
- Give clear and accurate instructions for eco-friendly actions through collaborative digital tools.
- Recognise and classify recyclable materials accurately according to their types (paper, plastic, glass, organic).
- Develop creativity and digital awareness by designing short digital materials (posters, postcards, messages) to promote environmental awareness.
- Write and share short process descriptions about eco-friendly practices through guided writing and digital platforms.
- Present eco-friendly processes effectively using visual and digital support.

Course Objectives

- E7.9.L1. Students will be able to understand phrases and the highest frequency vocabulary about environment.
- E7.9.L2. Students will be able to follow how a simple process is described in clear oral texts.
- E7.9.SI1. Students will be able to talk about obligations.
- E7.9.SI2. Students will be able to give simple instructions for a specific process.
- E7.9.SP1. Students will be able to give a simple description or presentation of a process.
- E7.9.R1. Students will be able to identify specific information in various texts about environment.
- E7.9.W1. Students will be able to write short, simple messages about environment.
- E7.9.W2. Students will be able to write short description of a process.

Related Skills

- Active listening
- Communication
- Critical thinking
- Collaboration
- Creativity
- Digital skills
- Problem solving

PREPARATION

Learning Approaches, Methods, Strategies

- Cooperative learning
- Gamification
- Interactive learning
- Problem-based learning
- Storytelling
- Station technique

Tasks

Teacher

- Designs the lesson using gamified and interactive digital tools.
- Prepares matching, classification, and multiple-choice activities.
- Gives clear instructions and models tasks.
- Encourages the students to talk about environmental obligations.
- Provides feedback and monitors group collaboration.
- Facilitates discussions on environmental awareness.

Student

- Participates actively in digital games and activities.
- Classifies recyclable materials into the correct groups.
- Follows instructions and completes eco-friendly tasks.
- Works collaboratively to prepare digital products.
- Expresses ideas and responsibilities about environmental protection.
- Engages with digital content and reflects on learning.

Instructional Tools / Technologies

The web tools provided in this scenario are offered as examples. Teachers are free to select and apply any tool they see fit, according to the web tools category. It is recommended that teachers review the web tool in question before use and have a good understanding of the tool's interface.

Hardware

- Interactive whiteboard

Online Tools

- eba.gov.tr
- Web tools for matching activities
- Gamification web tools
- Digital story creation tools
- Interactive presentation tools
- Animation creation tools
- Web tools for short answer questions
- Web tools for fill-in-the-blank questions

Instructional Materials/ Tools

- Waste materials (plastic bottles, cardboard, paper, tin cans, etc.)

APPLICATION

Activities

Before the Lesson

The teacher asks the students to complete the Vocabulary Exercise 1: Environment activity from EBA, in which they match the given environment-related words with the corresponding images that represent these words. The teacher uses one of the web tools for matching activities to design activities titled Environment and Sort the Waste. The teacher also creates a digital story titled Small Steps, Big Changes utilising one of the animation creation tools (Annex-1). The teacher designs another activity named Green Steps Game using one of the gamification web tools.

Lesson 1 (Class)

Pre-Activity

The teacher implements the Environment matching activity as a warm-up. The students are asked to drag and drop each keyword to its correct definition. The activity includes environmental words such as energy, rubbish, pollution, and recycle.

While Activity

Following the matching activity, the teacher continues with the Sort the Waste activity. In this task, the students are given words such as newspaper, jar, bottle, apple, etc., and are required to place them into the correct recycling bin. This activity reinforces vocabulary related to waste materials, promotes environmental responsibility, and allows the students to apply their knowledge in an interactive way.

After this activity, the teacher introduces the animation Small Steps, Big Changes (Annex-1). The students listen to the animation, and the teacher asks them higher-order thinking questions to encourage critical reflection, reasoning, and deeper understanding of the topic. To promote peer interaction and collaboration, this stage can be conducted as pair or group work; after the teacher's initial questions, the students may continue by asking and answering questions with each other. For example, the teacher may ask: 'Why do you think recycling is important for our future?' or 'What can people do if they forget to separate their waste?'

Post-Activity

The teacher implements the gamified exercise Green Steps Game as a wrap-up activity, where the students listen to sentences about eco-friendly actions and tap pairs of tiles to find the matching ones. This enjoyable and dynamic game not only raises environmental awareness but also supports listening comprehension and helps the students reinforce key vocabulary in an engaging way.

Related Skills: Collaboration, Communication, Critical thinking, Digital skills

Before the Lesson

The teacher designs an activity titled Guess Game using one of the gamification web tools. The teacher also creates an animation titled Save Our Planet using one of the animation creation tools (Annex-2). Finally, the teacher uses one of the web tools for matching activities to prepare a matching activity named Green Solutions.

Lesson 2 (Class)

Pre-Activity

The teacher implements the Guess Game to engage the students and activate their prior knowledge. In this activity, the students examine a visual (for example, a picture of a forest) and try to guess the word. They first say individual letters aloud and then attempt to predict and pronounce the complete word correctly. This activity helps the students recall vocabulary and prepares them for the main part of the lesson, as a warm-up.

While Activity

Following the warm-up activity, the teacher introduces the animation Save Our Planet (Annex-2). The students watch and listen to the story, which includes key expressions such as: "We must recycle," "We have to save energy," and "We shouldn't waste water." The teacher pauses at key moments during the animation to ask short questions and actively involve students in the process. To make the activity more engaging, the teacher can add a simple note-taking task during the animation. The students can write short notes about what we should and shouldn't do to protect the environment. They can use their notes to write a few simple sentences before the question–answer activity. After watching, the teacher asks higher-order thinking questions to encourage critical reflection, reasoning, and deeper understanding of the topic, such as: "What can we do to save our planet?", "Which eco-friendly habit do you like most?", "How can you help the Earth at home or at school?", etc. Through these questions, the students are encouraged to share their own ideas, reflect on daily habits, and use target language structures such as: "We must" and "We have to" while expressing their thoughts about saving the planet.

Post-Activity

The teacher moves on to the Green Solutions activity and asks the students to drag and drop each item into its correct group. The task includes eco-friendly actions such as: "We have to use energy-saving bulbs" and "We must plant more trees", etc. Through this digital matching activity, the students demonstrate their understanding of environmentally friendly habits and classify examples according to their correct categories.

Related Skills: Critical thinking, Communication, Collaboration, Digital skills, Problem solving

Before the Lesson

The teacher designs an activity titled Eco-Friendly Actions using one of the web tools for matching activities. The teacher also prepares another activity titled Our Environment using one of the interactive presentation tools (Annex-3). In addition, the teacher develops a third activity named Actions using one of the web tools for short answer questions. The students are required to bring waste materials from home to design a recycling product.

Lesson 3 (Class)

Pre-Activity

The teacher begins the lesson with the Eco-Friendly Actions activity as a warm-up. The students are asked to follow the instruction to look at the visuals, click on the pin under each picture, and choose the sentence that best matches the visual. This interactive activity helps the students recall environmental vocabulary and actively engage in the lesson.

While Activity

Following the warm-up activity, the teacher continues with the Our Environment activity (Annex-3). In this stage, the students explore different types of environmental problems, such as air pollution, water pollution, and waste, through visual materials and short discussions. The teacher encourages the students to observe the visuals carefully, express what they see, and share their opinions about the causes and possible solutions to these problems. This activity helps the students develop environmental awareness and use related vocabulary in meaningful contexts.

After the presentation, the teacher applies the station technique to help the students explore different environmental problems. Around the classroom, several stations are prepared with titles such as air pollution, water pollution, deforestation, global warming, and waste. Each station includes a related picture or short text. The students work in small groups and rotate from one station to another. At each station, they discuss the problem and write one short solution or suggestion; for example, “We should plant more trees” for deforestation or “We must stop throwing garbage into rivers” for water pollution. After visiting all stations, each group shares one idea with the class.

Then, as a follow-up activity connected to each station’s theme, the students use waste materials they bring from home (plastic bottles, cardboard, paper, tin cans, etc.) to design reuse or recycling products. For example, at the water pollution station, they can create a water filter model from plastic bottles; at the deforestation station, mini flower pots from waste bottles; at the air pollution station, windmills from plastic bottles; at the global warming station, a solar-powered vehicle model; and at the waste station, a recycling box. Each group then presents its product to the class and shares its solution idea. This activity sequence promotes collaboration, communication, and critical thinking skills while allowing students to use environmental vocabulary in context.

Post-Activity

The teacher moves on to the Actions activity as an assessment task. At this stage, the students look at the picture and use the hint to write the correct word or word group, such as reuse, recycle, or save energy. This activity helps the teacher assess the students' understanding of eco-friendly actions and related vocabulary.

Related Skills: Active listening, Creativity, Critical thinking, Communication, Collaboration, Digital skills, Problem solving

Before the Lesson

The teacher designs an activity titled Recycling Challenge using a gamification web tool (Annex-4). Moreover, the teacher creates another activity titled Environmental Problems using one of the digital story creation tools (Annex-5). Finally, the teacher develops a third activity titled Our Planet using one of the web tools for fill-in-the-blank questions (Annex-6).

Lesson 4 (Class)

Pre-Activity

At the beginning of the lesson, the teacher conducts the Recycling Challenge as a fun warm-up activity (Annex-4). In this activity, the students are shown two waste items, such as a plastic bottle, and a banana peel. The teacher asks questions like "Which bin should this go into?" or "Where does this item belong?" The students choose the correct recycling bin—plastic, paper, glass, metal, or organic. This activity helps the students recall what they know about recycling, promotes environmental awareness, and creates an engaging start to the lesson.

While Activity

After the warm-up activity, the teacher continues with the Environmental Problems digital story (Annex-5). The students watch a short digital story about a girl who notices pollution in her neighbourhood and decides to take action to protect nature. The story highlights major environmental problems such as air pollution, water pollution, and plastic waste. After watching, the teacher asks comprehension and reflection questions such as: "What problems did the girl see?", "What actions did she take?", and "What can we do to keep our environment clean?". The students are asked to share their ideas and examples from daily life, showing awareness of environmental problems and suggesting simple, eco-friendly solutions.

Post-Activity

The teacher uses the Our Planet activity for assessment (Annex-6). The students are instructed to read the text carefully and then complete the fill-in-the-blank questions to show their understanding of the passage. This activity enables the teacher to evaluate the students' reading comprehension, vocabulary knowledge, and ability to interpret meaning, rather than simply copying information from the text.

Homework/Assignment

The teacher assigns the students to create a digital poster on an environmental theme, using one of the interactive presentation tools. Each student will select one eco-friendly action, for instance saving water, recycling, planting trees, or reducing plastic use, and design a poster that communicates the message clearly and engagingly. The poster should include a title that reflects the action (e.g. Save Water, Save Life), at least three digital visuals or icons that illustrate the steps, and two simple sentences giving instructions or examples (e.g. Turn off the tap while brushing your teeth. Recycle plastic bottles.). To make it more impactful, the students are encouraged to add a short slogan that raises awareness. This assignment not only enables the students to practice vocabulary and writing skills but also encourages creativity and responsibility for the environment while effectively using interactive presentation tools.

Related Skills: Critical thinking, Communication, Collaboration, Digital skills

Evaluation/Assessment Methods/Tools

- Web tools for matching activities
- Web tools for short answer questions
- Web tools for fill-in-the-blank questions

REFERENCE

Related Links

This area is provided for the purpose of accessing the links included in the scenario. It is expected that the relevant links will have been checked and prepared prior to the commencement of the lesson.

1. EBA- Vocabulary Exercise 1: Environment: https://meb.ai/0swzBQ (Retrieved September 24, 2025)
2. Environment: https://meb.ai/Uo9jxb4 (Retrieved September 24, 2025)
3. Sort the Waste: https://meb.ai/olXvBM (Retrieved September 24, 2025)
4. Small Steps, Big Changes: https://meb.ai/aEI2it (Retrieved September 24, 2025)
5. Green Steps Game: https://meb.ai/rQSQaF (Retrieved September 24, 2025)
6. Guess Game: https://meb.ai/UpWVSgS (Retrieved September 24,2025)
7. Save Our Planet: https://meb.ai/ULBja3I (Retrieved September 24,2025)
8. Green Solutions: https://meb.ai/Uafljdx (Retrieved September 24,2025)
9. Eco-friendly Actions: https://meb.ai/Ue3e0js (Retrieved September 24, 2025)
10. Our Environment: https://meb.ai/UoXoZa3 (Retrieved September 24, 2025)
11. Actions: https://meb.ai/MVP3VP (Retrieved September 24, 2025)
12. Recycling Challenge https://meb.ai/xAY0Cv (Retrieved September 24, 2025)
13. Environmental Problems: https://meb.ai/VWkrwJ (Retrieved September 24, 2025)
14. Our Planet: https://meb.ai/AjRqf1 (Retrieved September 24, 2025)

Sources

Canva. (2025). *Eco-friendly steps-environmental problems.* Retrieved September 24, 2025, from https://www.canva.com/design/DAG1szAUTjU/ECkyCuiPvOu3ZZMZGQiORQ/watch?utm_content=DAG1szAUTjU&utm_campaign=designshare&utm_medium=link2&utm_source=uniquelinks&utlId=h3da446ca79

Canva. (2025). *Eco-friendly steps-our environment*. Retrieved September 24, 2025, from https://www.canva.com/design/DAG1q7PLn7s/UwoTVqsDX1H8Au1UROSHng/view?utm_content=DAG1q7PLn7s&utm_campaign=designshare&utm_medium=link2&utm_source=uniquelinks&utlId=h9db77537d2

Canva. (2025). *The images employed for activity representations in web tools* [have been devised by the D3 project team authors using Canva.]. Retrieved September 24, 2025, from https://www.canva.com/design/DAG3oXvlhH0/PAUpOX2rg-kpfWIEUPn6oA/view?utm_content=DAG3oXvlhH0&utm_campaign=designshare&utm_medium=link2&utm_source=uniquelinks&utlId=h597b4ec16b

Genially. (2025). *Eco-friendly steps-recycling challenge*. Retrieved September 24, 2025, from https://view.genially.com/6859bfeb47c2c46d8a6618da/interactive-content-eco-friendly-steps-recycling-challenge

LearningApps. (2025). *Eco-friendly steps-actions*. Retrieved September 24, 2025, from https://learningapps.org/watch?v=paoodyy4525

LearningApps. (2025). *Eco-friendly steps-eco-friendly actions*. Retrieved September 24, 2025, from https://learningapps.org/watch?v=p17f5com325

LearningApps. (2025). *Eco-friendly steps-guess game*. Retrieved September 24, 2025, from https://learningapps.org/watch?v=pdhkdtmn525

LearningApps. (2025). *Eco-friendly steps-our planet*. Retrieved September 24, 2025, from https://learningapps.org/watch?v=pifa3hnqn25

Powtoon. (2025). *D3-Eco-friendly steps-save our planet*. Retrieved September 24, 2025, from https://eba.powtoon.com/public-powtoon/?public_link_token=ceBXsIQ3jT4puNZyQJGg2-h4QGowX7BtyFWB_OyRz6Y

Powtoon. (2025). *D3-Eco-friendly steps-small steps, big changes*. Retrieved September 24, 2025, from https://eba.powtoon.com/public-powtoon/?public_link_token=qN5IBKHoInHB0rBVQOu-0BoyZminSfHAQjfXOVADfuQ

Ministry of National Education. (2018). *English course curriculum (primary and secondary school 2nd ,3rd, 4th, 5th, 6th, 7th and 8th grades)*. Board of Education. https://mufredat.meb.gov.tr/programlar.aspx

Ministry of National Education. (2024). *Education information network (EBA)*, Directorate General for Innovation and Education Technologies, Türkiye. https://eba.gov.tr

Wordwall. (2025). *D3-Eco-friendly steps-environment*. Retrieved September 24, 2025, from https://wordwall.net/resource/98786148

Wordwall. (2025). *D3-Eco-friendly steps-green solutions*. Retrieved September 24, 2025, from https://wordwall.net/resource/98825260

Wordwall. (2025). *D3-Eco-friendly steps-green steps game*. Retrieved September 24, 2025, from https://wordwall.net/resource/98717986

Wordwall. (2025). *D3-Eco-friendly steps-sort the waste*. Retrieved September 24, 2025, from https://wordwall.net/resource/98824437

Visual Sources

You can access the visual source of this scenario by scanning the QR code

Attachments

Annex-1: The Transcript of 'Small Steps, Big Changes' Animation
Annex-2: The Transcript of 'Save Our Planet' Animation
Annex-3: Our Environment Presentation Content
Annex-4: Recycling Challenge
Annex-5: The Transcript of 'Environmental Problems' Digital Story
Annex-6: Our Planet Activity

The Transcript of 'Small Steps, Big Changes' Animation

Description: The teacher uses the text below to create an animation by using one of the animation creation tools.

Page 1: Small steps, big changes.

Page 2: Small steps can make big changes.

Page 3: Energy – Turn off the lights when you leave the room.

Page 4: Water – Save water. Every drop counts.

Page 5: Recycling – Recycle and reuse.

Page 6: Nature – Plant more trees and keep the parks clean.



The Transcript of 'Save Our Planet' Animation

Description: The teacher uses the text below to create an animation by using one of the animation creation tools.

Teacher: Today we will talk about problems of our environment. Look at the pictures on the board. Share your solutions, please!

Teacher: The first problem is deforestation. Share your solutions, please.
Jack (boy): We must plant more trees.
Emily (girl): We have to protect the forests.

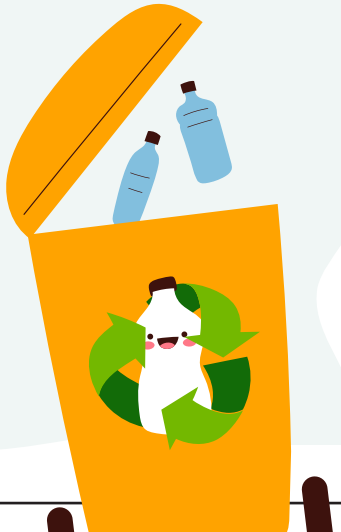
Teacher: The next problem is waste of energy. Share your solutions, please.
Sarah (girl): We must turn off the lights when we don't need them.
Tom (boy): We have to use energy-saving bulbs.



Teacher: The third problem is global warming. Share your solutions, please.
Anna (girl): We must reduce the use of cars.
Michael (boy): We have to use renewable energy.

Teacher: The fourth problem is air pollution. Share your solutions, please.
David (boy): We must plant more green areas in cities.
Lily (girl): We have to use public transportation.

Teacher: The last problem is water pollution. Share your solutions, please.
James (boy): We have to use water carefully.
Sophia (girl): We must not throw rubbish into rivers or seas.



Teacher: Thank you for your great ideas and solutions.
Well done, everyone.

Our Environment Presentation Content

Description: The teacher uses the text below to create a presentation by using one of the interactive presentation tools.

Page 1:

Our Environment



Page 2:

What is environment?

The environment is everything around us — air, water, land, animals, and plants.

It provides us with food, water, and shelter.

Page 3:

Environmental Problems

1.Air Pollution

2.Water Pollution

3.Deforestation

4.Global Warming

5.Plastic Waste



Page 4:

Causes of Pollution

1.Factories and cars release harmful gases.

2.People throw garbage into rivers and seas.

3.Cutting down trees destroys habitats.



Page 5:

Effects on the Planet

- Ice melting and rising sea levels
- Animals losing their habitats
- Air pollution causing health problems
- Climate change and extreme weather

Page 6:

What Can We Do?

Small actions, big changes!

1.Turn off the lights

2.Save water

3.Recycle and reuse

4.Use public transport

5.Plant trees

6.Say no to plastic bags

Page 7:

Even one person can make a big difference.

Let's keep our planet clean, green, and beautiful!



Recycling Challenge

Read the questions and choose the correct answer.

1. You have an empty bottle.
Where should you throw it?
A) Glass bin
B) Metal bin
C) Paper bin
D) Plastic bin

2. You finish reading a newspaper.
Which bin should it go in?
A) Metal bin
B) Organic bin
C) Paper bin
D) Plastic bin

3. You eat a banana and have the peel left.
Where should it go?
A) Glass bin
B) Organic bin
C) Paper bin
D) Plastic bin

4. You drop and break a cup.
Which bin should you use?
A) Glass bin
B) Metal bin
C) Organic bin
D) Plastic bin

5. You drink a soda and have an empty can.
Where should you throw it?
A) Glass bin
B) Metal bin
C) Organic bin
D) Paper bin



The Transcript of 'Environmental Problems' Digital Story

Description: The teacher uses the text below to create a digital story using one of the digital story creation tools.

Page 1:
Environmental Problems

Page 2:
It was a sunny morning.
Lila walked to school, listening to the birds singing.
She loved the trees, the fresh air, and the blue sky.
"Nature is amazing," she whispered with a smile.

Page 3:
But that day, something was different.
The air smelt bad, and the park near her house was full of plastic bottles and cans.
"What happened here?" Lila asked sadly.

Page 4:
In science class, Mrs. Green showed some pictures of polluted rivers and grey skies.
"These are the results of pollution," she explained. "Our planet is in trouble."

Page 5:
After school, I couldn't stop thinking about it.
I wanted to help. So, I decided to start with small actions:
I turned off the lights when I didn't need them, saved water while brushing my teeth, and used a reusable bottle instead of plastic.

Page 6:
Next weekend, I went to the park with a big bag and gloves.
I collected the rubbish and put it into recycling bins — one for paper, one for plastic, and one for glass.
Some people saw me and started to help. That made me so happy! I will protect the Earth every day.
Small actions lead to big changes!



Page 7:
The end.

Our Planet Activity

Our Planet

People all around the world cause many environmental problems that harm our planet. One of them is deforestation. When people cut down trees for houses or farms, animals lose their homes, and the air gets dirty. Another major problem is pollution. Factories and cars release harmful gases into the air, and people throw garbage into rivers and seas. These actions kill fish and other sea animals. The third problem is global warming. Because of greenhouse gases, the temperature of the Earth is rising, and ice in the polar regions is melting. We must save energy, recycle, and plant more trees to protect our world before it's too late.

QUESTIONS

Read the text carefully and complete the blanks by selecting the appropriate word from the two options provided.

1. Cutting down _____ destroys the natural homes of animals and makes the air dirty. decoration | trees

2. When people pollute the air and _____, it harms both animals and humans. water | weather

3. The smoke from factories makes the _____ very difficult to breathe. air | area

4. Melting ice in the polar regions happens because of _____. global meeting | global warming

5. People can help the planet by planting _____ and saving energy. streets | trees

6. If people continue to waste _____ and cut trees, the world will become hotter. decoration | energy

7. Recycling helps to reduce _____ and protect nature. pollution | population

8. The writer believes that we must take _____ now to save the Earth. action | attention

Answer Keys

Annex-4

1. D
2. C
3. B
4. A
5. B

Annex-6

1. trees
2. water
3. air
4. global warming
5. trees
6. energy
7. pollution
8. action